



CONFIGURING OUR DYNAMIC SYMMETRY GRID - BLADE RUNNER 2049 - PART TWO

Alright everyone, welcome back for **part two** of [Blade Runner 2049](#) Analyzed Cinema. Huge thanks for all of the amazing and continued support!

Today we are going to take a look at some more amazing design and **composition** techniques used in **visuals** from the Blade Runner 2049 trailer. If you haven't checked out part one yet, go for it. I introduce a new root rectangle for cinematographers, compare things to the rule of thirds, and steer you in the right direction.

This time, we are going to learn about areas of the grid to **avoid**, and see how we can configure the **dynamic symmetry** grid to fit our needs. Let's get into it!

Official Trailer

Here is the trailer just in case you haven't drooled over the visuals yet. Watch how they use lighting and design to communicate each beautiful scene.

[BLADE RUNNER 2049 Trailer - For Educational Purposes Only](#)

Earn Brownie Points by Avoiding Areas of the Root 6

Patterns in composing your subject should be **avoided**. Master painters used the root rectangles over and over again, but with each design they aligned the main subject on a different diagonal, vertical or horizontal. They **overlapped** root rectangles (see [#419](#)), used different **themes** (see [#438](#)) and created something fresh and powerful every time. This is one of the detrimental **flaws** of the rule of thirds. If everyone is using the same generic, predictable method of composition and believing that a certain part of the frame is more magical than any

other, then we are all going to have the same looking scenes, paintings, or photos. Allow me to explain further.

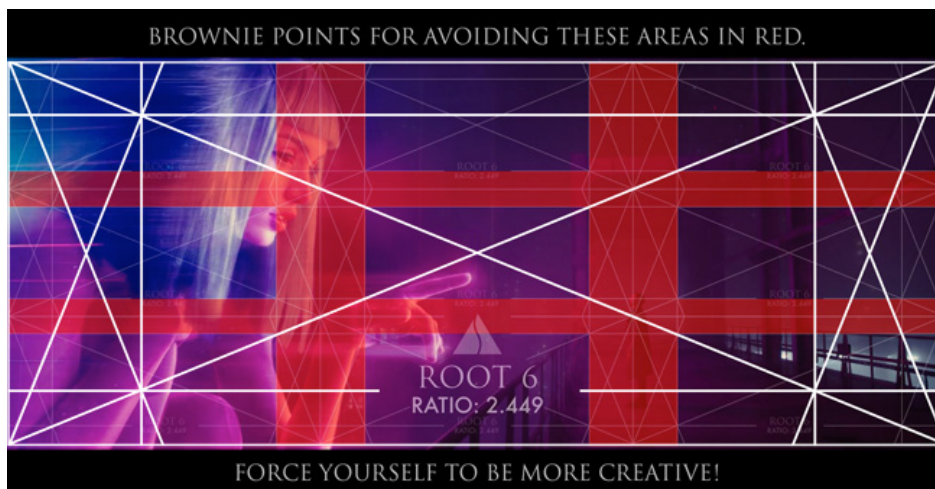
On May 19th I watched the new **movie** "Alien - Covenant" and it was pretty **dreadful**. I was watching for nice lighting, composition, and design. I only saw a few scenes that caught my eye, and the speaking characters were generically **plotted** on the rule of thirds 90% of the time. Yawn, boring! Give us some freakin' eye candy! I even saw some missed opportunities with **separated shapes** (see [#374](#)). Ok fine, let them remain **mediocre**, but what about the rest of us that want to set our stuff apart from the rest?? We need to use a **system** that allows us the flexibility for creativity and not monotony. This is why we use dynamic symmetry and design techniques.

If I mention the TV show **Mr. Robot** (see [Day 411](#)) you immediately know that their cinematography is marveled for the way it goes against the **status quo** (ROT). So, I offer **brownie points** if you force yourself to be more creative than placing your subject or a main point of interest in the same area. Use the grid to inspire more diagonals and different perspectives...high, low, extreme negative space, extreme close-ups, unique lighting scenarios, etc. Not that you can't ever place anything in this area, it's just a way to influence creativity.

Below you'll see the areas in red to avoid. They are similar to the rule of thirds, so the reason to avoid plotting subjects within these areas is to force creativity and avoid falling into the same category as ROT. Take risks when organizing your characters. Go from plotting, to organizing a design.

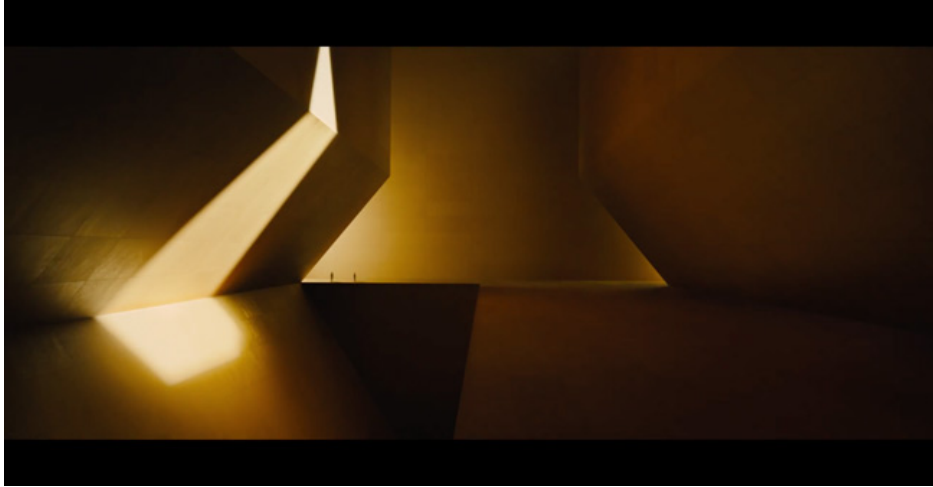
You must always keep **balance** in mind, and a great way to understand this is to know **gazing direction** (see [Day 99](#)) and **breathing room** (see [Day 102](#) & [104](#)).

**As mentioned earlier, we can use many different grid themes, so if you don't want to worry about avoiding these areas, try a different theme.*



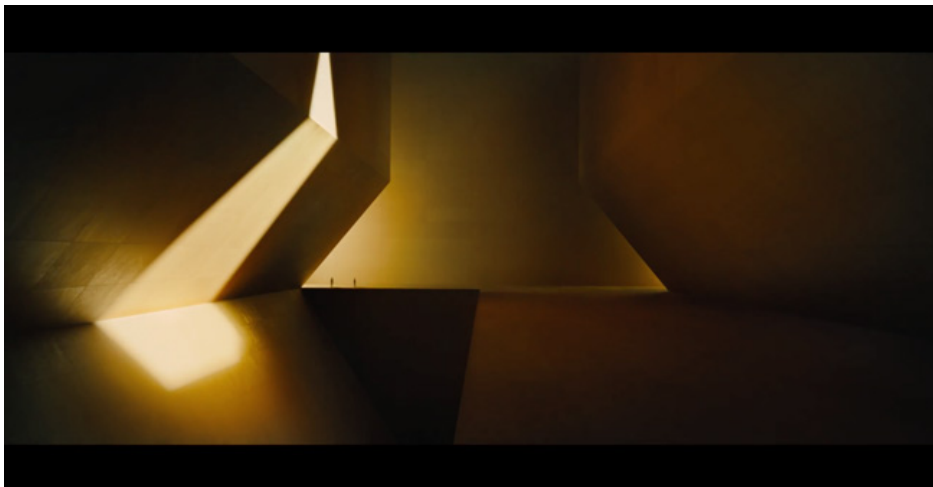
Developing our Root 6 for Cinema

This next shot is pretty amazing as well! Ok, I can say the same about most of the visuals, but wow, look at this! Triangular shapes have a way of mesmerizing us (see [Day 87](#)). We can even see aerial perspective being captured as the sun creates a **flare** of light onto the surface...creating an atmosphere of warmth.



From what I'm learning about light, the shadows should appear cooler, or bluer, but I guess that is for another article since we are focusing on composition and design.

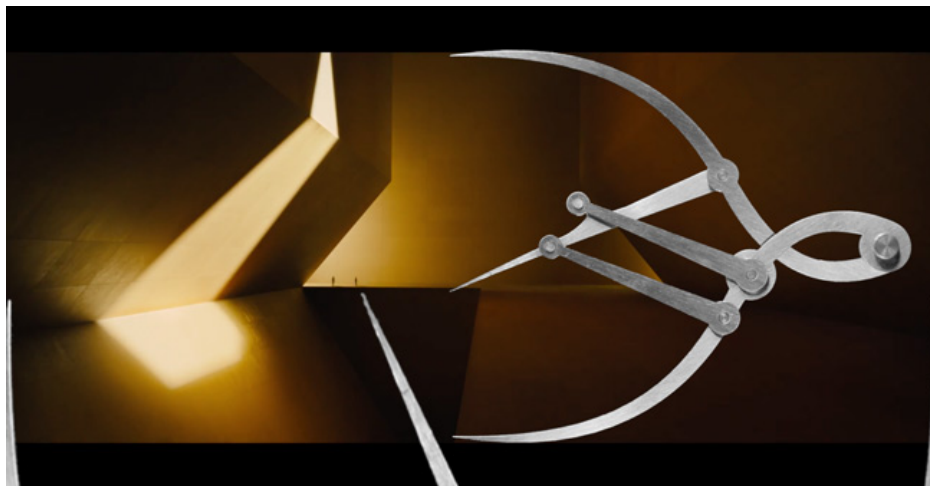
I tried to edit the image below to show what I mean. The blue of the shadows mix with the yellow of the light and create a greenish shadow area.



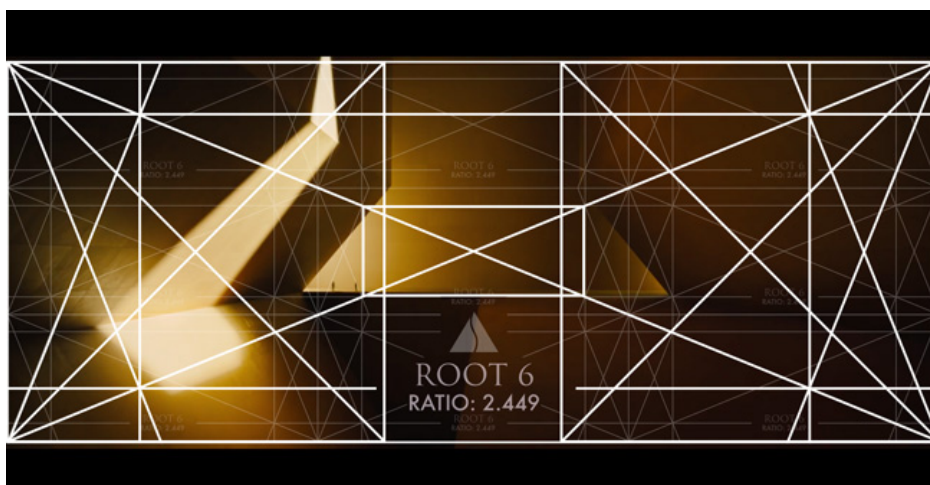
We can see main horizontals and verticals lining up to our root 6, but let's compare it to our phi calipers. This will show you how we can adjust our grid to fit our shooting needs and style.



Here we can see two measurements with our **phi calipers** (horizontal and vertical) which shows the placement of the subject and the dominant horizontal. Not that cinematographers will be carrying around calipers to design their shot, but this gives you something else to consider in terms of proportion and organization.

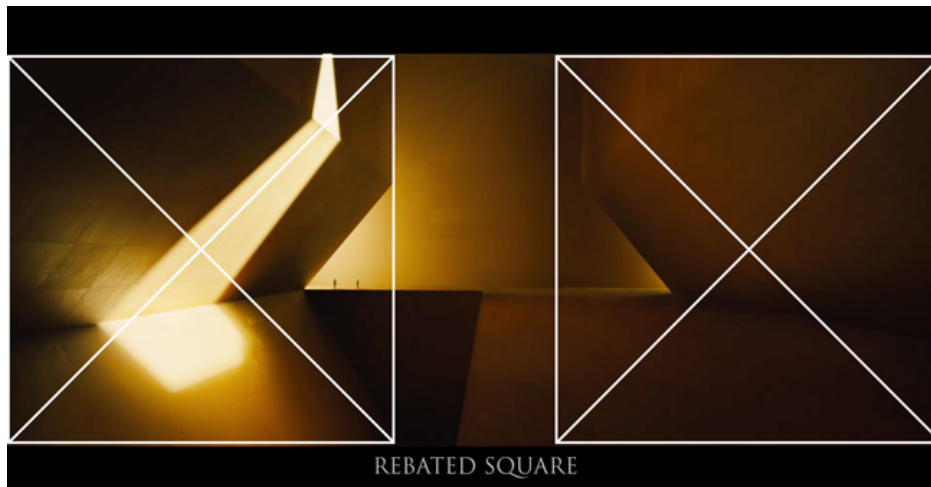


Let's adjust our root 6 rectangle to incorporate the phi alignments. I'll place it in the center, which actually creates a smaller root 6.



You might be thinking, "Ok, this is all fine and dandy, but what about those sexy diagonals?" Well, when we align this scene to the **rebated square** (see [Day 7](#)), we can see how the **45 degree** angles and the edge of the square come into play. We can even see how the light on the left creates a **90 degree angle** (see [Day 76](#)) as it hits the surface.

You can see in examples further down how they line objects up with the **edge** of the square to create a hidden **geometric shape**.



So, we adjust our grid further and get what some might think of as **perfection**. We can adjust this grid system in many ways to fit our needs as we capture our stunning visuals. The grid system I believe they used in the movie trailer was the **root 6:3x**, so I will analyze the rest of the visuals to that grid configuration in Part 3.



Conclusion

Well, that was a ton of stuff to soak in! We learned how we can create and adjust our root 6:3x grid to benefit our needs. We can incorporate phi alignments, or the rebated square. We can do anything we want, mix it up, but most importantly, avoid mediocrity.

Thanks again everyone, I appreciate all of The Master Pass members! Stay tuned for part 3 where we'll look at the rest of the visuals from the trailer. See you next time!

...to be continued